DAY 1 · AWS LINUX LAB

Naming Conventions

Cross-cutting reference

Every naming pattern established across the lab so far — AWS resources, admin vs. service accounts, systemd units, and log/config files.

This file is a reference, not a walkthrough — check back here whenever you name something new in later days.

Local — your machine | Remote — the server | Config file | Concept | Gotcha | Best practice | Paths

Core philosophy

Every name should tell you, at a glance, what it's for and what category it belongs to:

- ✓ `type` / `workload` / `env` / `region` fields for cloud resources
- ✓ `adm-` / `svc-` prefixes instantly separate a human's admin account from a service's unattended account
- ✓ Consistent 1:1 naming between a service and its supporting files (unit file, log folder, logrotate config) so nothing requires memory to trace

Updated rule · Cloud naming moved to the professional pattern `<type>-<workload>-<env>-<region>-<instance>`, the widely used Microsoft Cloud Adoption Framework style. Patterns 1 and 2 show the old form crossed out. Day 1 resources still carry the old names, e.g. `aws-lab-ubuntu-01`.

The patterns

1 AWS resources (key pairs, VPCs, subnets, security groups...)

`<type>-<workload>-<env>-<region>-<instance>`

Type first so resources group in lists; short region codes. Example: `kp-ubuntu-lab-eun1-001`

Replaces ~~`aws-<env>-<purpose>-<id>`~~

2 EC2 instances

`vm-<workload>-<env>-<region>-<instance>`

Same rule with type `vm`. Example: `vm-ubuntu-lab-eun1-001`

Replaces ~~`<env>-<purpose>-<id>`~~

3 Personal sudo/admin username

`adm-kiwi`

Dots are invalid in Linux usernames — only letters, digits, `_` and `-`. Example: `adm-kiwi`

4 **Service accounts**

`svc-<purpose>`

No login shell, no sudo. Example: `svc-disk-report`

5 **Systemd unit files**

`<purpose>.service`

No extra prefix — location + extension already say what it is. Example: `hello-loop.service`

6 **Log directories**

`/var/log/<service-name>/<service-name>.log`

One dedicated folder per service. Example: `/var/log/disk-report/disk-report.log`

7 **Logrotate config files**

`/etc/logrotate.d/<service-name>`

No extension — matches the `.d` folder convention. Example: `/etc/logrotate.d/disk-report`

Quick reference

What	Pattern	Example
AWS resource	`<type>-<workload>-<env>-<region>-<instance>`	`kp-ubuntu-lab-eun1-001`
EC2 instance	`vm-<workload>-<env>-<region>-<instance>`	`vm-ubuntu-lab-eun1-001`
Personal admin user	`adm-kiwi`	`adm-kiwi`
Service account	`svc-<purpose>`	`svc-disk-report`
Systemd unit	`<purpose>.service`	`hello-loop.service`
Log directory	`/var/log/<service-name>/`	`/var/log/disk-report/`
Logrotate config	`/etc/logrotate.d/<service-name>`	`/etc/logrotate.d/disk-report`

Common type prefixes

Type	Prefix	Type	Prefix
EC2 instance	`vm`	Security group	`sg`
Key pair	`kp`	Subnet	`snet`
VPC	`vpc`	Route table	`rt`
Internet gateway	`igw`	NAT gateway	`nat`

Part of the AWS/Linux sysadmin lab · indexes day1-aws-ssh-firewall, day1-linux-users-accounts, day1-systemd-service and day1-cron-logrotate